# DAVIDE TAGLIALATELA

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HARVARD
UNIVERSITY


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**Education**

**Harvard University**
Ph.D. Economics, 2020 to 2027 (expected)

**Bocconi University, Italy**
M.Sc. Economic and Social Sciences, 110/110 cum laude, 2020
B.Sc. Economic and Social Sciences, 110/110 cum laude, 2017

**Fields**

Financial Economics
Behavioral Economics
Climate Finance

**References**

Professor Xavier Gabaix
Harvard University
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Professor Andrei Shleifer
Harvard University
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Professor Marco Sammon
Harvard Business School
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Professor Adi Sunderam
Harvard Business School
asunderam@hbs.edu

**Fellowships, Grants & Awards**

Dissertation Completion Fellowship, Harvard Griffin GSAS, 2026–2027
Molly and Domenic Ferrante Economics Research Fund, 2026
Ross Garon and Anna Suh Family Foundation Economics Research Fund, 2025
Certificate of Distinction in Teaching, Derek Bok Center, Harvard University, 2022, 2023
Bocconi Graduate Merit Award, Bocconi University, 2017

**Teaching**

Teaching Fellow, Harvard University
Capital Markets (undergraduate), Daniel Graves, Spring 2026
Corporate Finance (undergraduate), Daniel Bergstresser, Fall 2025
Capital Markets (undergraduate), Weiling Liu, Spring 2025
Quantitative Methods in Economics (undergraduate), Davide Viviano, Spring 2025
Capital Markets (undergraduate), Xavier Gabaix and Matthew Pritsker, Spring 2023
Psychology and Economic Theory (Ph.D.), Matthew Rabin, Fall 2022, Fall 2023

**Research**

Research Assistant, Harvard University, Professor Andrei Shleifer, 2022–2025
Research Assistant, Harvard University, Professor Matthew Rabin, 2021
Research Assistant, Harvard University, Professor Stefanie Stantcheva, 2019–2020
Research Assistant, Harvard University, Professor Alberto Alesina, 2018
Visiting Student, IGIER, Bocconi University, Professor Francesco Giavazzi, 2018–2020

**Job Market Paper**

**What a Disaster Means: Attention, Interpretation, and the Demand for Green Assets**

How does the interpretation of an event shape portfolio responses, flows, and prices? Using large language models fine-tuned to classify 1.5 million articles from U.S. news outlets, I construct a novel measure of local interpretation that separates the attention a disaster receives from whether

the event is framed as a manifestation of climate change. Among disaster-affected counties, stronger climate interpretation leads to reallocation toward green ETFs by household-serving advisers, about 20% of pre-event green-ETF holdings per ten percentage points over two quarters. The relationship extends to ESG mutual-fund inflows, as well as to nearby fund managers, who tilt their active trading toward greener firms as climate-linked coverage rises. Predetermined county and investor characteristics and the direct economic effects of the disaster are not driving the responses. To separate local interpretation narratives from investors' own prior beliefs, I use supply-side variation in interpretation, driven by changes in the ownership structure of local outlets: under a larger chain ownership, the climate-interpreted share of local disaster coverage is lower, and the local response toward sustainable assets attenuated. At the aggregate level, stronger climate interpretation of national disaster coverage is associated with higher flows into ESG funds. If a year's disasters drew the attention of the entire institutional investor base, an interquartile increase in climate interpretation would imply appreciation of green stocks of up to 15% of the observed annual green return spread.
[Latest draft available here]

**Papers in Progress**

"Are You Asking the Right Questions? An Experiment on Investors' Demand for Information" (with Marcela Carvalho and Beatrice Ferrario)

Measures retail investors' mental models through their revealed information demand: the questions they ask an AI chatbot while making incentivized investment decisions.

"The Structure of Disagreement: Belief Systems and Cultural Divides in the United States"

Estimates how latent belief systems link views across issues, and how those links shape which views change when the environment changes.

**Seminars & Conferences**

New England Economics Ph.D. Conference (Brown University, 2025)

**Ph.D. Summer Schools & Other Training**

Financial Economics of Climate and Sustainability (FECS), Global Doctoral Reading Group, Salata Institute, Harvard University, Spring 2026
Deep Learning for Dynamic Stochastic Models, University of Turin, 2025
Large Language Models in Finance, Barcelona School of Economics, 2025
NLP and Large Language Models, Barcelona School of Economics, 2025
Computational and Experimental Economics, BESLab, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, 2023
Princeton Initiative: Macro, Money and Finance, Princeton University, 2022
Behavioral Finance, Yale University, 2022
Summer Institute in Behavioral Economics, Russell Sage Foundation, 2022
Using Text as Data: Methods and Applications, Barcelona School of Economics, 2021
Summer School in Advanced Statistics and Probability – Random Graphs and Complex Networks: Structure and Function, Bocconi University, 2019
Tools for Macroeconomists: Advanced Tools, London School of Economics, 2018

**Languages**

Italian (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate)

**Software skills**

R, Python, MATLAB, Julia, LaTeX, JavaScript and HTML/CSS (for Qualtrics applications), Excel, and Access (*International Computer Driving Licence*, Advanced Certificate, 2016)

**Personal information**

Citizenship: Italian
Voice type: Baritone
Boxing stance: Southpaw